$b is 7

The output shows that the original variables were not affected.

The next code example passes values to the function by reference. The original variables are changed inside the swap() function.

swap2.php

```
<?php

function swap(&$a, &$b) {

    $temp = $a;
    $a = $b;
    $b = $temp;
    echo "Inside the swap function:\n";
    echo "\$a is $a \n";
    echo "\$b is $b \n";
}

$a = 4;
$b = 7;

echo "Outside the swap function:\n";
echo "\$a is $a \n";
echo "\$b is $b \n";

swap($a, $b);

echo "Outside the swap function:\n";
echo "\$a is $a \n";
echo "\$b is $b \n";

?>
```

We use the & character to pass values by reference.

```
function swap(&$a, &$b) {
```